that language anymore. Especially with the rise of microservices, it's possible that you can program in Ruby and Elixir at the same company!

Ruby is a language founded with joy at its core, which leads to several non-technical aspects that make it an appealing language: a healthy foundational philosophy, a strong community, and continual improvement. Let's go over each point and how it benefits Ruby.

Solid Foundations

Yukihiro Matsumoto (Matz) created Ruby with a philosophy that programmers who use it should feel joy. To this day, his philosophy influences the design of the language, the way that libraries are built, and everything about Ruby.

The happiness of programmers is just as important as what those programmers create because happiness affects all aspects of one's life. Businesses benefit from this as well. A happy programmer is more likely to be happy with their job, stay with their company, and create a better product.

A Strong Community

Matz's philosophy is felt in the community and is captured in the phrase "Matz is nice, so we are nice" or MINSWAN.[2] The Ruby community is welcoming and helpful, which is critical for the adoption of a language over time. New developers won't want to learn a language if they are pushed away due to negativity.

Another strength of the Ruby community is a culture of testing. This might be obvious to people who have spent a lot of time with Ruby, but it's certainly not true in all language communities. Having a culture of testing creates better libraries and applications. This testing culture contributes to joy over time.

Continual Improvement

Ruby isn't a static language. The language doesn't push many breaking changes (this would certainly not elicit joy), but it has continued to evolve. Many smart people and companies deliver performance improvements, increased security, and even large projects like type checking.

Plus, Ruby's major libraries have continued to innovate over the years. Ruby on Rails 7[3] is the best release of Rails yet. It continues to set a high bar for programmer productivity and happiness.

2. https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/MINASWAN
3. https://rubyonrails.org/